So far, we've seen queries that don't really exhibit the full power of Elasticsearch; they just fetch data without much intelligence. Occasionally, we may want to issue a query with criteria: for example, searching for first edition books by a particular author with an overall rating higher than four stars. The real power of Elasticsearch is hidden in the flexibility and depth of its search functionality. The next few sections look at this at a high level.

2.3 Full-text search

Once you've indexed a number of documents, it's important to be able to find those that meet specific criteria. Elasticsearch provides search functionality to search unstructured text in the name of full-text queries.

> **NOTE** Unstructured text (also called full text), just like natural language, doesn't adhere to a particular schema or model like structured text. Modern search engines work hard on full text to draw relevant results. Elasticsearch provides a rich set of matches and other queries to work with full-text data.

2.3.1 Match query: Books by an author

Say, for example, that a reader visiting our bookstore wants to find all titles authored by Joshua Bloch. We can construct the query using the `_search` API with a `match` query: a `_match` query helps search for words across unstructured or full text. The following query searches for books authored by "Joshua."

Listing 2.7 Querying for books authored by a specific author

```
GET books/_search
{
  "query": {
    "match": {
      "author": "Joshua"
    }
  }
}
```

In the request body, we create a `query` object defining a `match` query. In this query clause, we ask Elasticsearch to *match all documents authored by Joshua across all books in our index*. Read the query as if you are reading prose in plain English, and try to digest the essence of it.

Once the query is sent, the server analyzes the query, matches the query with its internal data structures (inverted indexes), fetches the document(s) from the file store, and returns them to the client. In this example, the server finds the single book authored by Joshua Bloch and returns it, as shown in figure 2.13.